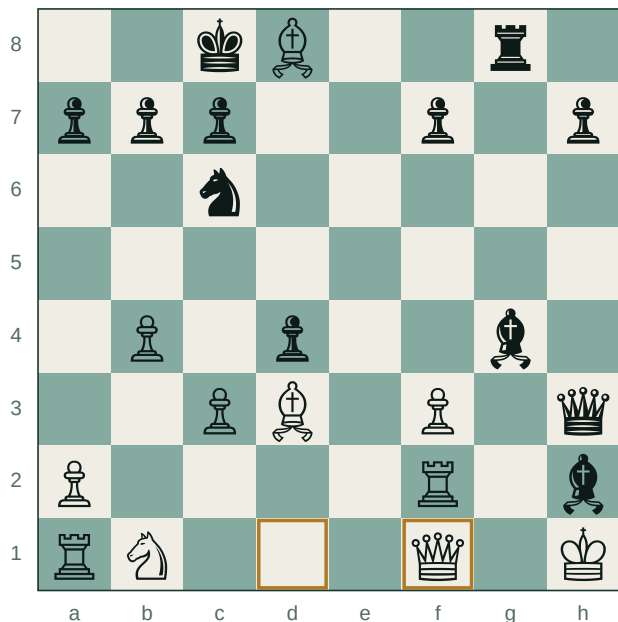


Discovered checks: Black, move 20

Discovered checks

Black to move



Previous move: 20.Qf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20...Bxf3+ 21. Rxf3 Rg1+ 22. Qxg1 Bg3+ 23. Qh2 Qxh2#

20...Bxf3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on f3. Recorded reply: **21.Rxf3**.

21...Rg1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From g1 it attacks king on h1 and queen on f1. Recorded reply: **22.Qxg1**.

22...Bg3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the queen on h3 attacks the king on h1. Recorded reply: **23.Qh2**.

23...Qxh2# Mate: queen on h2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d8 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.